Track 3: Autonomous AI Teammates

Settled

Haan ya na?
Paytm asks before it charges.

For Paytm’s Soundbox, the payment speaker shops rent for about ₹125 a month. A yes is saved. A no stops the charge.

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Problem statement

Paytm shopkeepers get charged rent they never agreed to.

The salesman says

“Sirf ₹1 mahina.”

Next month

₹125 is cut from his payout.

Then

He complains and waits weeks.

Real complaints, 2023 to 2026

“...charged me Rs 125 monthly for 5-6 months automatically from my payments.”

App Store · Oct 2024

Box returned, but Soundbox rent still deducted.

Complaint site · Mar 2026

“My Rs 950 payment was adjusted against a Soundbox Monthly Rental... I have never ordered...”

LinkedIn · May 2026

Real complaints from Paytm merchants, 2023 to 2026. 1.64 crore merchants pay Paytm a subscription (Q2 FY27).

Proposed solution

Ask first, then charge

Before the first rent, Settled calls the shopkeeper in their language and asks one thing: did you agree to this plan?

“Haan”

Rent runs and the yes is saved. Honest sign-ups go through untouched.

“Na” or unsure

Rent is held. Settled offers the real plans so he can pick one, or books the box pickup, and tells the salesman’s manager.

No answer

Rent is held. It tries again, then a person calls.

Demo

Ramesh says na. Nothing is charged.

"1 November se Soundbox ka ₹125 mahina lagega. Aapne yeh plan liya tha? Haan ya na?"

Rent of ₹125 a month starts 1 Nov. Did you take this plan?

"Na bhaiya, usne ₹1 bola tha."

No, he said ₹1.

"Theek hai, abhi kuch nahi katega. Main asli plans samjhata hoon, ya box wapas le jaayein?"

Okay, nothing is charged. Shall I explain the real plans, or pick up the box?

Rent due 1 Nov — demo data

Gupta Kirana	"Haan"	**Charged, yes saved**
Ramesh, Sharma Store	"Na, he said ₹1"	**Held, plans sent**
Verma Dairy	Box never delivered	**Not charged**

Then: Ramesh can pick a real plan, so the sale is saved honestly.

Technology and tech stack

Sarvam for the voice, plain code for the money

Voice

Hears and speaks Hindi and other Indian languages, by phone or Soundbox (Sarvam Saaras v4, Bulbul v3).

Understanding

Understands mixed answers like “haan, par ₹1 bola tha” and hears when someone else answers. Questions go to a person (Sarvam-105B).

Rules

Code, not the AI, decides each charge. Every decision is logged.

Paytm systems

Built like Paytm’s own tools. Rent, pickup and manager steps are mock-ups for the hackathon.

Records

Reads delivery, plan and sign-up records. If one can’t be reached, it asks a person.

Testing

62 simulated shopkeepers in 7 Indian languages, scored by our own code. All 62 come out right, and no rent is charged after a “na”.

USP: what's different

A chatbot can ask. Settled can stop the money.

01 **Holds the money**

The charge waits in Paytm's payout system until there's a yes.

02 **Checks the records**

Delivery, return and plan records, before anyone is asked.

03 **Knows who said yes**

Even if the salesman taps "agree" himself, Settled calls the shopkeeper's bank-linked number.

04 **Saves the sale honestly**

After a "na", it offers the real plans so the shopkeeper can pick one, or books the pickup.

Impact and benefits

Who gains, and how we'll measure it

0

charges after a shopkeeper says "na"

1 day

target to settle a dispute, vs Paytm's 2-day promise

62

simulated shopkeepers in 7 Indian languages, scored by code

For shopkeepers

No surprise charges
Asked in their own language
A quick answer if they dispute

For Paytm

Fewer disputes and tickets
Proof behind every charge
Mis-selling found early
Merchants who stay

If 1 in 100 of 1.64 crore subscribers disputes a charge, that's about 1.6 lakh tickets.

Business model

Fewer disputes now, more merchants who stay

Now

New Soundbox sign-ups

Ask before the first rent. Fewer disputes, fewer tickets.

Next

Every recurring charge

Plan upgrades, loan deductions, insurance: same ask, same proof.

Later

Honest sales pay

Every “na” is tied to a salesman and area, so sales pay can reward honest sign-ups.

Why it pays: fewer refunds and support tickets now, and merchants who stay keep borrowing.
Over half of Paytm’s merchant loans go to repeat borrowers (Q1 FY27).

Our ask: a pilot on new Soundbox sign-ups.